Ben Lovell

Software Developer

Hi, I'm Ben, an experienced Senior Software Engineer with a **proven track record** of delivering **high impact projects**, enhancing workflows, and **fostering technical expertise** in fast paced software development environments.

LINKS

Email	ben@lovell.io	Bluesky	@ben.lovell.io
Website	https://ben.lovell.io	Mastodon	@socksy@toot.cat
Github	socksy	LinkedIn	benjlovell

SKILLS

Fluent:	Clojure & ClojureScript • Python • Backend Architecture • Dev Tooling • PostgreSQL • Infrastructure • Data Intensive engineering • Microservice design (REST + async) • CI/CD
Proficient:	Infrastructure as code • Ruby (+ Ruby on Rails) • TypeScript/JavaScript • React • Nix • Docker • Cassandra • Kafka
Familiar:	Scala • Go • Rust • HTML/CSS • Kubernetes • MongoDB • Compilers/ Parsers

EXPERIENCE

Present Day
↑
June 2025

Senior Software Engineer - **Tower**

Berlin, Germany

Contributed to CLI tooling, backend infrastructure, and developer experience for Tower's serverless Python platform. Core contributor across the Rust CLI, Go/Rust/ TypeScript monorepo, and infrastructure:

- **led,** architected and implemented the development of an MCP (Model Context Protocol) server in the Rust CLI and a Claude Code plugin built on it, proving critical for adoption
- **hardened** run execution for a key partner evaluation: built load testing harnesses to find the platform's saturation points, then fixed what they exposed — graceful shutdown with drain mode, runner reconnection with challenge-response identity verification, and adoption of orphaned Kubernetes pods after runner restarts
- **built** cron scheduling end-to-end, from data model and public API through to a Redis-backed scheduler with distributed locking
- **led** migration of all telemetry to Grafana Cloud (OpenTofu-provisioned), introducing end-to-end distributed tracing of runs across HTTP, gRPC and Redis boundaries
- **improved** reactivity and reduced backend load & frontend data consumption by introducing a shoulder tap SSE/fetch system
- **designed** and built the Organizations multi-tenancy system end-to-end, including database migrations, API changes, and billing integration
- **parallelized** Go test suite with isolated databases, reducing test runs from ~1m30s to ~5s, and eliminating flaky tests

Rust ◇ Go ◇ TypeScript/React ◇ Terraform ◇ PostgreSQL & Redis ◇ Nix

June 2025
↑
September 2024

Freelancer & Open Source - **Self Employment**

Berlin, Germany

Took time between roles for contract work and open source contributions.

- **helped** designed and implement a dependency injection framework in Rust for a client
- **contributed** packages to NixOS
- **worked** on some small projects for a Clojure TUI, incident response management, clojure.berlin

`Rust ◇ Nix ◇ Clojure/Babashka ◇ Terraform`

April 2024
↑
January 2019

Senior Software Engineer - **Pitch Software GmbH**

Berlin, Germany

Contributed to the development of Pitch's backend and frontend systems, working over 4 different product areas and ending up specializing in the offline-first sync system. Some of the stuff I worked on:

- **introduced** a reproducible development environment and tooling, improving workflows and productivity across engineering team using a combination of nix, docker, bash and Python
- **led** a cross-team documentation working group, making technical onboarding smoother and improving internal knowledge sharing
- **took** initiative to fix many frontend (CLJS/React) and backend (CLJ/Postgres) problems, gaining buy-in from leadership with cost/benefit analyses
- **designed** and implemented improvements to the core sync system to address data loss and developer productivity issues in the offline first functionality, working with senior leadership on a long-term roadmap
- **mentored** junior engineers, guiding them through their first feature implementations and fostering technical growth

`Clojure/ClojureScript ◇ PostgreSQL ◇ Docker ◇ AWS ◇ TypeScript ◇ Nix`

December 2019
↑
March 2017

Backend Data Engineer - **Geeny/Telefonicá Next GmbH**

Berlin, Germany

Hired as part of the full time expansion of the Geeny IoT Cloud platform from Telefonicá Next GmbH, in order to build a data privacy first IoT solution I've:

- **architected** a microservices infrastructure on AWS with Docker, Kafka and HTTP/JSON
- **analysed** and translated product requirements into technical implementations
- **delivered** 3 crucial Clojure services under a month-long time constraint
- **led** the effort to have a 15-repo continuous integration and deployment process with GitLab CI/CD, reducing the release cycle from weeks to minutes

`Scala ◇ Clojure ◇ Kafka ◇ Postgres ◇ Docker ◇ AWS ◇ Kubernetes ◇ Protobufs`

Red Pineapple Media GmbH Software Engineer *April 2015 – February 2017*

I was brought on to help the urgent rewrite of the video ad delivery system from PHP using a modern Clojure stack. Key role in system design and performance.

`Clojure ◇ MySQL ◇ Cassandra ◇ OpenRTB ◇ Gatling ◇ AWS`

Skyscanner Ltd Intern at Change the Market (R&D) *June 2013 – August 2013*

Built a better R&D frontend interface by writing a small DSL & parser (in JavaScript).

`Parser/Compiler writing ◇ Python`

lifelife UG Full Stack Developer *November 2014 – April 2015*

Created a decoupled separate service to interact with the main Rails application. Implemented funnel metrics, multiple locale support, and more.

`Ruby on Rails ◇ Sinatra`

University of St Andrews Research Intern *June 2012 – July 2012*

Created a population simulation tool for demographic and graph db testing.

EDUCATION

University of St Andrews 2.1, BSc (Hons) in Computer Science *2010 – 2014*
Heavy practical education with subjects including:
Data Encoding, Artificial Intelligence, Operating Systems, Computer Architecture, Knowledge Discovery and Datamining, Programming Language Design and Implementation (PLDI)

OUTSIDE RESPONSIBILITIES

Clojure Berlin Meetup Co-Organizer *October 2016 – Present*
Part of a small team taking turns to MC, filling in for lack of speakers, and keeping our 900 member meetup connected

ClojureBridge Berlin Orga Team Member and Coach *Summer 2015 – Summer 2017*
Conducted outreach, triaged attendee invitations, organized catering, etc.